

Tuesday, August 18

Matthew was up at 6. I didn't think that he was quite ready so I held him by the crib. His head rested on my shoulder and his arms were relaxed but his legs kicked back and forth. I took him into the living room. I read and Matthew pushed the brass tri-light around the floor. Eventually it tipped over and he did something else.

Once everyone was up we ate breakfast, washed and then packed everything into the cartop carrier. I mowed the lawns. We left. We gassed up at Esso. Cheryl asked Peter to read the pump numbers. He stood with his nose six inches from the pump and counted as the numbers turned over.

The drive to P.A. seemed short. We drove into heavy cloud. Matthew slept the whole way. Peter checked the distance every few miles. Cheryl and I talked. At P.A. we wandered around Eaton's looking for a clown handing out the balloons that Matthew was pointing at. No luck. We went for dinner in the mall and left by 1.

Rain was steady from P.A. to Waskesiu. The girl at the park gates said that sunshine was forecast for tomorrow. We got into our cabin #216 of Bakers', set out the clothes and food in the two bedrooms and kitchen area. We drove to the Nature Centre at 2:30, looked at the stuffed animals, got word of a Grey Owl film at 4:00 and left.

Cheryl fed Matthew fruit at a cook site on the beach. Peter and I walked to the end of the breakwater and back. Cheryl met us and we walked to the stores. Cheryl bought bread and peanut butter, we talked with Ernie Krahn by the movie theatre and returned to the Nature Centre to see Grey Owl. Peter sat on a stump in front of my chair and questioned everything he saw. Matthew woke up and since I had seen this before I took him into the observation wing. We looked at the animals. Matthew touched one lightly. It wobbled a bit as if alive and he pulled back. I could see a wall of mist rising from the lake some distance away as a storm approached. When it hit, a line of water dripped from the ceiling. I talked briefly with a naturalist.

Peter and Cheryl were out by 5. Peter was touched by the trapping scenes. A bear film is showing tomorrow. He is eager to see it. We were home shortly. Supper was sandwiches. Matthew was starved. Cheryl drove to the townsite for a cookie pan. She came back with chocolate-fudge cookies.

I read *The Hobbit* to Peter. Bilbo is in the mountain. Matthew pushed his crib around the floor. Both boys were tired. Peter went to bed at 7:30. Matthew ate a banana and finally went to bed. Cheryl read *Chatelaine* and crunched crab apples.